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MiniMax (0100.HK)

M3.1 Flash Release: Reshaping Enterprise Agent Economics

CITI'S TAKE

Similar to our takeaways from DeepSeek's recent V4.1 Flash-1017 release, we view MiniMax's M3.1 Flash (released Oct 19) as another pivotal milestone highlighting the industry's shift toward enterprise-grade agentic workflows and lower inference unit economics. By delivering improved execution across coding, chained tool calling, and computer operations at significantly lower price points, MiniMax's M3.1 Flash strengthens its competitive position and could accelerate its B2B monetization across developer and enterprise ecosystems. These two back-to-back releases reinforce our view that China's AI battleground is pivoting from parameter scaling towards inference cost efficiency and end-to-end agentic workflow integration. We expect peer model labs to follow suit with enhanced agentic capabilities in upcoming release cycles. We maintain our Buy rating and Target Price on MiniMax.

Buy / High Risk	
Price (16 Oct 26 16:10)	HK$182.10
Target price	HK$576.00
Expected share price return	216.3%
Expected dividend yield	0.0%
Expected total return	216.3%
Market Cap	HK$64,187M
	US$8,179M

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What's new? On Oct 19th, MiniMax announced the release of M3.1 Flash, (previously tested anonymously as *Space Bunny* with over 200T tokens processed). The latest model demonstrates improvements across complex agentic tasks, software engineering, computer use, and cybersecurity. The model is now available via the MiniMax API, MPlan, and MiniMax Code, with open weights planned for release at a later date. More specifically, MiniMax noted that M3.1 Flash possesses nearly 3x faster in inference speed while the usage cost has been reduced by 70%.

Agentic & benchmark performance: We highlight notable improvement of M3.1 Flash: **1) Enterprise Workflow & Complex Agent Tasks** where M3.1 Flash is ranked at the very top on AutomationBench-AA for multi-SaaS cross-functional workflows as it demonstrates its skill in solving practical problems across Sales, Marketing, Operations, Customer Service, Finance, and HR. It also achieved **76.2 on BankerToolBench** for multi-step planning, financial compliance, and chained tool execution. 2) **Software Engineering:** The model achieved high score at **73.7% on DeepSWE v1.1**, demonstrating autonomous end-to-end coding, debugging, and testing capabilities and long-chain task execution at lower cost. 3) **Computer Use:** M3.1 Flash scored **61.7 on OSWorld V2** and **29.6 on Agents' Last Exam (ALE)** (both #1 among Chinese models) for cross-application interaction in economically valuable scenarios. 4) **Cybersecurity:** The model achieved **82% on CyberGym**, excelling at vulnerability detection, penetration testing, and code auditing.

Model Pricing & Inference Efficiency - Attributed to its sparse attention architecture, M3.1 Flash delivers nearly 3x faster inference with routine output

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speeds exceeding **200+ TPS** and a median (P50) stability of **170+ TPS**. More importantly, overall agentic task cost for M3.1 Flash dropped by 70% and priced at RMB1 per million input tokens, RMB4 per million output tokens, and RMB0.1 per million cached tokens.

Figure 1. MiniMax M3.1 Flash benchmarks comparison

	MiniMax M3.1 Flash	DS-V4.1-Flash-1017	DS-V4.1-Flash	Kimi-K3	GLM-5.3
CoWork					
Automation-Bench v1.0.6	62.8	60.5	54.8	46.7	48.8
Banker ToolBench	76.2	-	73.7	69.1	74.5
GDP.pdf AA	20.8	-	12.8	22.0	11.2
Terminal Bench 4.0	38.1	42.3	31.2	12.6	37.9
LOCA-Bench 256K	60.3	-	-	49.7	50.3
Computer use					
Agents' Last Exam	29.6	-	-	28.3	-
OSWorld 2.0	61.7	-	54.3	58.3	-
Coding					
PostTrain Bench v1.1	39.3	-	30.5	36.6	37.5
DeepSWE v1.1	73.7	77.0	74.2	67.5	66.9
NL2Repo-Bench	61.2	68.2	65.4	58.0	58.0
SWE Refactor Bench	23.0	-	11.8	19.5	10.4
Network security					
CyberGym	82.2	-	-	80.0	84.5
General capabilities					
BabyVision (w/tools)	91.0	92.5	89.6	85.7	-
HLE (w/o tools)	43.4	42.6	39.2	43.5	42.3
CharXiv RQ	82.5	-	69.0	84.8	-

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Source: Company Reports, Citi Research

MiniMax

Valuation

We value MiniMax at HK$576, 7x 28E P/S, derived from 30% discount to average of historical 2-year forward trading P/S multiple at 10x. We are using 30% discount to reflect intense competitive landscape, high volatility on customers shifting to alternative models and potential delay and failure of M3 Pro release. Our latest revenues CAGR for 2025-30E is 160% and 120% for 2026-2029E. Our target price of HK$576 implies 13.3x our 2027E P/S, which we view as attractive compared to peer group.

Risks

We rate the Minimax stock High Risk to reflect its short trading history and uncertainties from an ever-changing AI environment. Risks that could impede the stock from reaching our target price include: 1) Fast evolution of models and intense competition; 2) Overhang from upcoming 6M lock-up expiration; 3) Constant capital funding needs; 4) FX fluctuation given USD is the reporting currency; 5) R&D talent retention and intellectual property infringement risks.

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Appendix A-1

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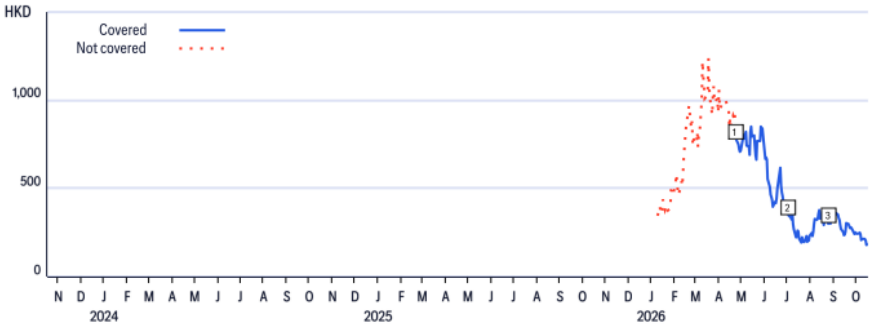
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MiniMax (0100.HK)

Ratings and Target Price History
Fundamental Research

Analyst: Alicia Yap, CFA



	Date	Rating	Target Price	Closing Price
1	24-Apr-26 06:28:21	*1H	*1,330.00	777.50
2	03-Jul-26 06:49:01	1H	*533.00	346.60
3	26-Aug-26 14:56:11	1H	*576.00	303.00

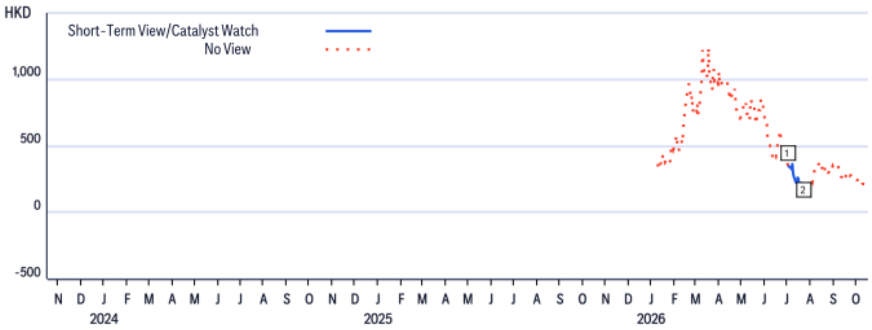
*Indicates Change

Rating/target price changes above reflect Eastern Time

MiniMax (0100.HK)

Short-Term View/Catalyst Watch Research

Analyst: Alicia Yap, CFA



	Date	Action	Expected Direction	Duration	Closing Price
1	03-Jul-26 02:49:01	Add STV	Downside	30 Days	346.60
2	24-Jul-26 01:48:38	Remove STV	Downside	30 Days	196.00

CW - Catalyst Watch , STV - Short-Term View

Rating/target price changes above reflect Eastern Time

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	12 Month Rating			Catalyst Watch		
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% of companies in each rating category that are investment banking clients	39%	43%	30%	42%	38%	36%

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